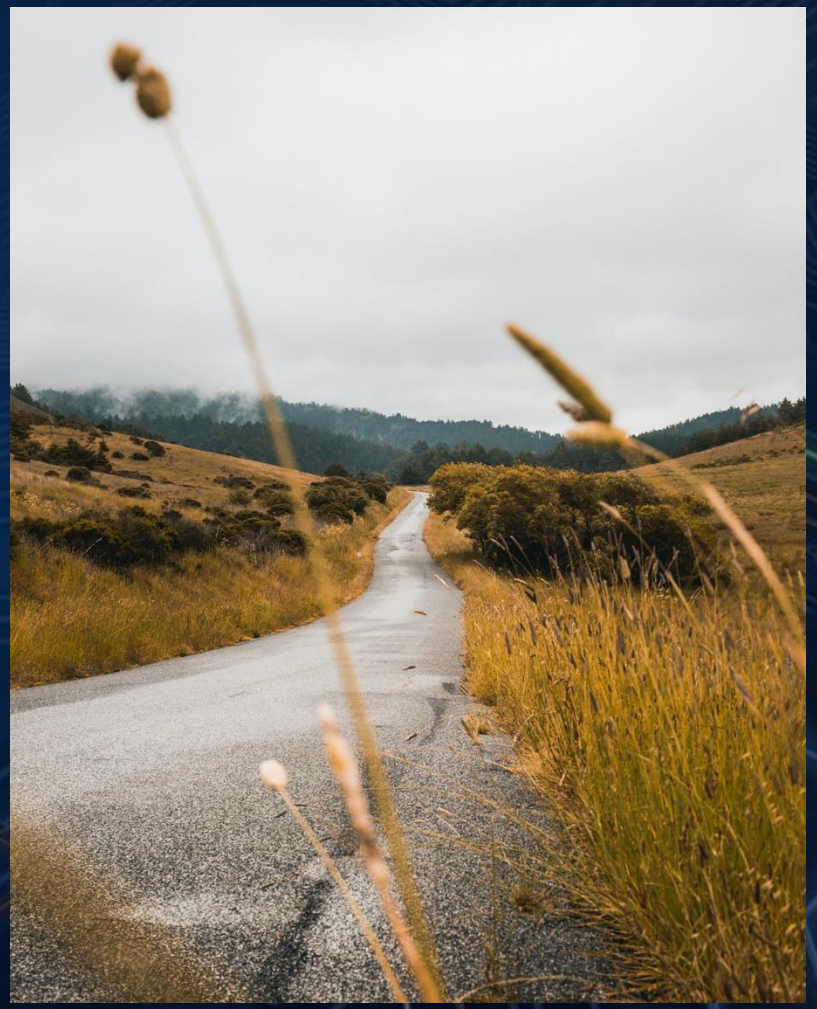
NIST PQC

The Road Ahead



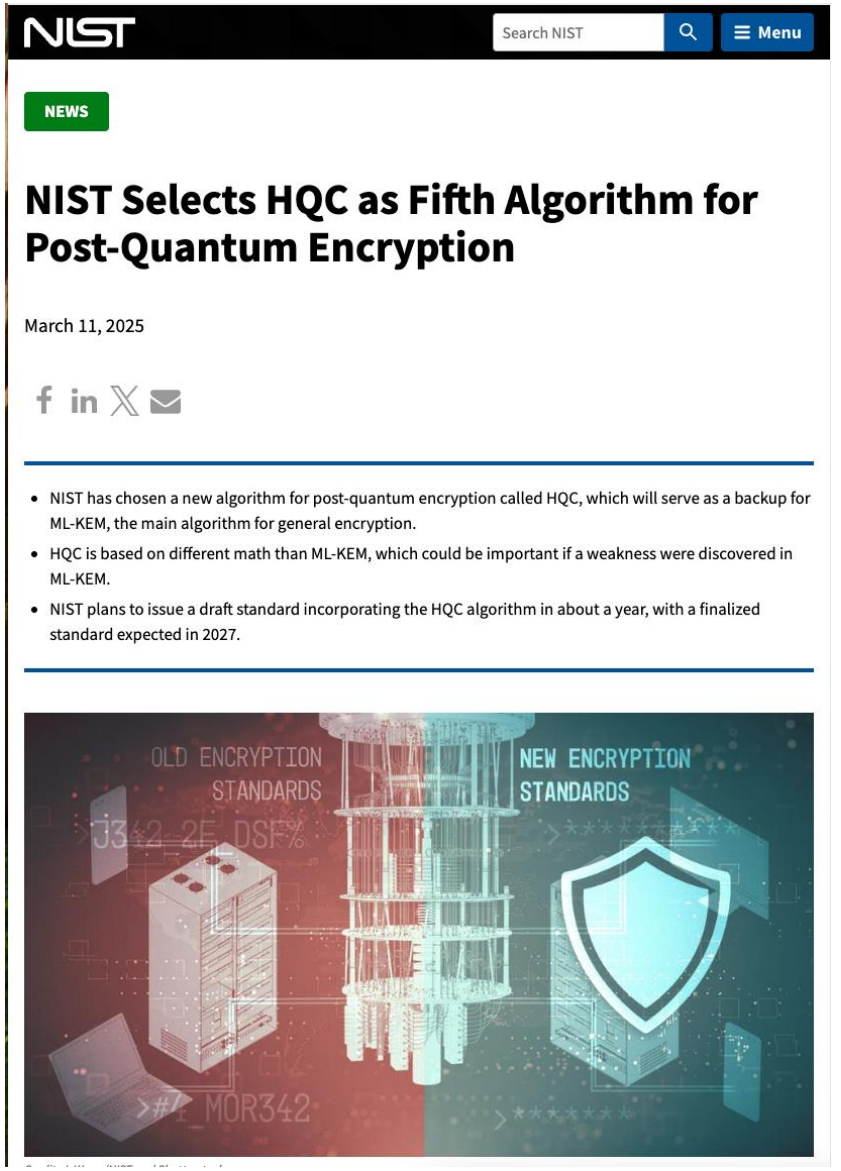
Dustin Moody
Cryptographic Technology Group

Tuesday, October 3rd, 2023

NIST NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF STANDARDS AND TECHNOLOGY
U.S. DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE

Here we are now

- March 11, 2025 – Selection of HQC marks the end of the 4th Round of the (main) NIST PQC process
- The process began in February 2016
- Some numbers
  - 82 submission packages
  - 278 submitters involved, from 25 countries in 6 continents
  - Over 3000 members on the pqc-forum and over 5000 posts
  - NIST has held 7 workshops, with over 2000 attendees
  - 11 NIST documents published (reports and standards)
    - Over 100 commenters on our first three PQC Standards


NIST

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Menu

NEWS

NIST Selects HQC as Fifth Algorithm for Post-Quantum Encryption

March 11, 2025

- NIST has chosen a new algorithm for post-quantum encryption called HQC, which will serve as a backup for ML-KEM, the main algorithm for general encryption.
- HQC is based on different math than ML-KEM, which could be important if a weakness were discovered in ML-KEM.
- NIST plans to issue a draft standard incorporating the HQC algorithm in about a year, with a finalized standard expected in 2027.